

Jacques Quass de Vos

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About me

Economist with 3+ years in government, research, and data analytics; currently completing an MSc in Economics (graduating March 2027) focused on causal inference and international economics. Combines applied research with production-grade data engineering. Particular interest in international trade, with a focus on Japan and Africa.

Education

The University of Osaka

Master of Science in Economics, Sustainable Economics Programme

Osaka, Japan

April 2024 – March 2027

- Intensive theoretical and empirical training in a highly selective 6-student international programme.
- Core coursework: macroeconomics, microeconomics, econometrics, international trade, labour economics, public finance, media agenda-setting, applied econometrics, and econometric analysis.
- Research: (1) TICAD and Japanese FDI in Africa; (2) endogenous trade costs and the Suez Canal disruption.

Stellenbosch University

Bachelor of Commerce in International Business

Stellenbosch, South Africa

Feb. 2019 – March 2023

- Selective four-year degree preparing students for careers in international business and consulting.
- Key modules: economics, statistics, financial management, investment management, urban economics, machine learning, politics, philosophy, global history, African economic history.
- Six-month exchange semester to Waseda University, School of Political Science and Economics in Tokyo.

Professional Experience

Associate Analyst (Data Scientist)

Codera Analytics

Remote

Aug. 2024 – present

- Notable project: Scraped and processed nearly 1 million news articles from five major South African newspapers (2010–present), creating a rich textual dataset for economic sentiment analysis.
- Design and maintain automated ETL pipelines in R/Python for Codera's EconData platform, processing international economic indicators, trade, and news data from ingestion through to visualisation.
- Lead custom research and analysis for clients in domains like international trade and African public finance.
- Publish regular data stories that drive client engagement and inbound interest.
- Identify new research topics and contribute to product development.

Junior Economist (Research, Policy and Planning)

Western Cape Government, Department of Economic Development and Tourism

Cape Town, South Africa

July 2023 – April 2024

- Led and co-authored economic update reports, strategic documents, and bespoke research projects; identified inefficient policies and proposed evidence-based alternatives adopted by stakeholders.
- Drafted parliamentary responses for the Provincial Minister of Finance and the Western Cape Premier.
- Delivered weekly macroeconomic briefings to senior departmental officials and external stakeholders.
- Co-authored Economic Impact Analysis of the Province's SMME Booster Fund during the COVID-19 pandemic—a high-profile report assessing emergency support to small businesses.
- Conducted rapid-response analyses including: tourism and film industry performance, restaurant sector trends, taxi strike impacts, and the anticipated costs of Europe's Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism.
- Received the highest possible rating on annual performance review.

Research Assistant

Stellenbosch University Japan Centre (SUJC)

Stellenbosch, South Africa

April 2023 – April 2024

- Supported major collaborative research projects and represented the Centre at international seminars.
- Published independent research articles and played a key role in developing the SUJC website.

Additional Experience

Travel Coordinator

Freelance

Osaka, Japan

Sept. 2025 – present

- Designed, planned, and coordinated a two-week luxury travel itinerary for 14 high net-worth individuals across Japan, managing suppliers across hospitality, transport, and guide services to provide a seamless experience.
- Saved over 50% on expenses such as chartered buses by thorough research and steadfast negotiation.
- Optimised logistics to minimise travel time and costs while meeting each client's unique requests.
- Core skills: logistics, project management, negotiation, customer satisfaction, networking.

Copywriter

Passion Posts

Remote

March 2022 – April 2023

- Authored over 120 blog posts—from industry/product analyses to recipes—for multiple clients.

Awards & Scholarships

MEXT Scholarship, Embassy Recommended

Japanese Government, Monbukagakusho

The University of Osaka

April 2024 – March 2027

Mitsubishi UFJ Trust Scholarship

Mitsubishi UFJ Trust Bank

Waseda University

Sept. 2022 – March 2023

Skills

Languages: English (native), Afrikaans (native), Japanese (JLPT N2, *sitting July 2026*), French (intermediate)

Technical: R, Python, Stata, SQL, Git, L^AT_EX, Google Cloud, RESTful APIs, Tableau, PowerBI

Quantitative methods: Causal inference (difference-in-differences, synthetic control, synthetic DiD, gravity models), panel data, time series, web scraping, NLP, machine learning

Policy domains: International trade, development economics, labor economics, public finance, urban economics

Additional

Graduation: March 2027

Nationality: South African

Visa Status: Student (Japan)

Hobbies: Hiking, guitar, cooking, jazz